If the result is not yet satisfactory, we can keep traversing each branch of the dendrogram repeating this step, until either:

- we reach a point were both branches have similar characteristics;
- we get the desired number of clusters (if we have an idea from domain knowledge);
- we are satisfied by the result of some metric we have defined (see next section);
- or we chose a threshold for the max depth we can traverse the tree, and we reach it.

Figure 12.23 shows how this would work for our example, assuming we are satisfied with traversing the dendrogram only up the first split; you can see that now, instead of a segment, we have a "*step function*" cutting through the reachability plot and the dendrogram. In figure 12.23, while we only retain 3 clusters, `CF`, `C6` and `C7`, we have left the border of all `CF`'s sub-clusters visible in the chart.